

years until he was finally forced to quit when his company would no longer allow him to work remotely while he lived abroad.

If you find you don't love what you're doing, you have the freedom to change your mind. If you want to make more money, you're free to do so. If you want to pursue something that doesn't make any money, you can do that, too. The need to make money doesn't keep you trapped doing anything you don't want to be doing.

The choice of an initial career that commands a high salary gives greater ability to start saving and investing more quickly. Whatever career or job you choose, it's important to negotiate the highest starting salary possible. When you get pay raises, they are usually based on a percentage of your salary, so you want this starting number to be as high as it can possibly be. Educate yourself by researching what comparable jobs pay in your area. Document the value you bring to a company. Don't just focus on listing credentials on your resume or in your interview. Have concrete examples of how you can add value by improving the company's bottom line by helping them cut spending or increase earnings. You can also leverage a competitive offer at any point and be ready to take that offer if your employer doesn't counter.